

FREE RESOURCE · AI & FINANCE AUTOMATION

10 Finance Tasks to Automate First

A prioritised checklist of the 10 highest-ROI finance processes to automate, with scoring guidance to identify your best starting point.

10 Process Priorities

Scoring Matrix

Common Mistakes

Free Download

10 processes

Scoring matrix

ROI focused

Actionable

How to Use This Checklist

Rate each process on two dimensions: **volume** (how many transactions per month) and **manual effort** (hours per week). Processes that score high on both are your highest-priority automation candidates. Use the ROI Calculator (premium resource) to quantify the business case for each.

#	Process	What to Automate	Related Resource
01	AP Invoice Processing	Automate three-way matching, GL coding, and ERP posting. Target: eliminate manual data entry for standard invoices.	AI Governance Checklist for Finance (free)
02	Expense Report Processing	Automate OCR receipt capture, policy checking, approval routing, and ERP posting via T&E platforms.	T&E Implementation Checklist (free)
03	Month-End Journal Entries	Automate recurring accruals, prepayments, and standard allocations. Finance team focuses on exceptions only.	Month-End Automation Opportunity Map (premium)
04	Bank Reconciliation	Automate transaction matching between bank statements and ERP. AI handles exceptions flagging.	Finance Automation Readiness Assessment (free)
05	Management Report Commentary	Use AI prompt templates to draft variance commentary from	AI Prompt Library for Finance Teams (free)

#	Process	What to Automate	Related Resource
		structured data inputs in minutes.	
06	Purchase Order Matching	Automate PO-to-invoice matching and goods receipt confirmation before payment release.	AP Invoice Automation Implementation Guide (premium)
07	Cash Flow Forecasting	Automate collection and consolidation of actuals; apply AI to pattern-detect cash flow anomalies.	AI-Powered Cash Flow Forecasting Template (premium)
08	FX Revaluation	Automate periodic revaluation of foreign currency balances and posting of revaluation differences.	Finance Automation Readiness Assessment (free)
09	Intercompany Reconciliation	Automate matching of intercompany transactions and automated elimination journal generation.	FP&A AI Transformation Toolkit (premium)
10	Audit Trail and Controls Reporting	Automate extraction and formatting of audit-ready transaction logs and controls evidence.	AI Governance Checklist for Finance (free)

Scoring Your Automation Opportunity

Score each process:	1 — Low	2 — Medium	3 — High
Transaction volume (monthly)	<100	100–500	>500
Manual hours per week	<2 hrs	2–8 hrs	>8 hrs
Error / exception rate	<2%	2–8%	>8%
Audit / compliance risk	Low	Medium	High

Processes scoring **10–12**: automate first. Processes scoring **6–9**: second wave. Processes scoring **4–5**: assess ROI carefully before committing.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

- ⚠ Starting with the most complex process — start with high volume, standard transactions where ROI is fastest
- ⚠ Ignoring data quality — clean master data before automation, not after
- ⚠ Underestimating change management — users who revert to manual processes eliminate the ROI entirely
- ⚠ Selecting a vendor before defining integration requirements — ERP connector compatibility is non-negotiable
- ⚠ Setting unrealistic auto-match rate targets — 85-90% is excellent for Year 1; 95%+ takes 12-18 months

About This Resource

Developed by **Mirela Dragulescu**, a finance transformation specialist with 9+ years delivering AI and automation programmes across European finance functions.

NEXT STEPS

The **Finance Automation Readiness Assessment** (free) is the recommended next step — it evaluates your team's readiness across data quality, skills, process maturity, and governance. The **Finance Automation ROI Calculator** (premium, €25) quantifies the business case for your top 3 priorities. Both are available in the Resources section on MD Consulting's website.

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